

and as such does not need a sales pitch again. You could, however, inform them about the latest updates available for your app.

A user expects to be within the web app, with all UI elements dedicated to the task at hand. The app exists in its own context and navigation scheme, and is external and independent from the web site's context or navigation scheme. When using a specific web app, a user is only aware of that particular app. When designing the web app, remember that it is an independent application, and not a part of a web site. Keep all relevant UI elements on top, and get rid of all unrelated ones.

A web app is completely different from the usual pattern of a logo in the header, menu on the side, detail links in the footer, and so on. Clear your mind of all web site designs and stress on user requirements; even better, think about how you'd want an app like that to look and feel like.

While making the UI as simple as possible, it often ends up dull. A good web app puts a premium on aesthetics without sacrificing usability.

Most modern browsers support Scalable Vector Graphics (SVG), canvas (a 2D drawing surface), CSS3 transforms and animations, new colour models, integrated native video, and professional fonts. There are even proposals for integrating 3D engines into browsers. Because these building blocks are all native to the browser, it is very easy to combine them for greater effect. For example, you can add rounded corners to video or make a CSS animation that uses new colour schemes.

With the UI and design taken care of, you can look at the following factors while developing your app.

### ► **Speed**

The importance of how fast your app delivers results can never be over-emphasised. None of us like to wait for a response (do we?). The responsiveness of a web app, both real and perceived, should be as fast as any normal application.

A web app is expected to be fast to match up to the speed at which the user works. Each second that he/she has to wait, translates to money you stand to lose. Research has shown that faster web apps make more money and rank higher in search results. A good web app feels and acts fast. 

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